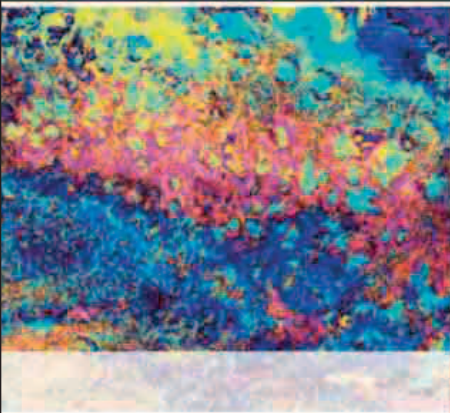




In 1991, Canadian geophysicist **Alan Hildebrand** (b.1955) announced that the **Chicxulub crater**, centered on the coast of the Yucatán Peninsula, Mexico, was almost certainly created by the impact that American physicist Luis Alvarez had hypothesized as the cause of the **extinction of the dinosaurs** (see 1980). The ages of the rocks and the size of the object that would have made the crater tallied well with Alvarez's hypothesis.

In November, Japanese physicist **Sumio Iijima** (b.1939) published his research into **nanoscale tubes of pure carbon**, known as carbon nanotubes. Although these tubes had been observed before, Iijima's work was inspired by the growing interest in carbon allotropes called fullerenes (see 1985) and helped develop it further.

American inventor **Roger Billings** (b.1948) revealed the first **electric vehicle powered by a hydrogen fuel cell**. In the same year, Japanese firm Mazda announced a concept hydrogen car with an internal combustion engine that burns hydrogen.

Global connections

This image represents a map of computer networks in the early 2000s. The World Wide Web is the sum of interconnected information that is stored on servers throughout this complex interconnected network.



May 1991 Sony announces MiniDisc digital audio format

June 1991 Carbon nanotubes discovered

July 1, 1991 The world's first call on a digital mobile phone network

June 19, 1991 American inventor Roger Billings unveils the first car to run on hydrogen fuel cells

August 6, 1991 The first ever web page goes live, at CERN, in Switzerland

September 1991 Discovery of the Chicxulub impact crater announced